Faydah Maniri Dumarpa

Atty. Faydah Maniri Dumarpa (born May 7, 1983) is a Filipino lawyer, public administrator, and human rights advocate serving as a Commissioner of the Commission on Human Rights of the Philippines (CHR). She was appointed by President Ferdinand Marcos Jr. on December 28, 2022, joining the Sixth Commission En Banc to serve a full seven year term running until 2029. A Maranao attorney with roots in Lanao del Sur, Dumarpa is the first Muslim woman ever appointed Commissioner in the history of the CHR, a distinction she herself has affirmed in public remarks before the United Nations.

Before stepping into this role, Dumarpa built a career of over two decades that touched all three branches of Philippine government. She worked in statutory research as a legislative officer in both the House of Representatives and the Senate, moved into corporate law with the National Power Corporation, and later took on senior administrative and financial posts in the executive branch, including at the National Nutrition Council and the Procurement Service of the Department of Budget and Management.

At the Commission, she now serves as Focal Commissioner for some of its most sensitive portfolios: gender equality and women's rights through the Gender Equality and Women's Human Rights Center (GEWHRC), the protection of persons deprived of liberty (PDLs), and the emerging field of human rights in technology, covering issues like data privacy, cybersecurity, and AI governance.

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Office

Commissioner, Commission on Human Rights of the Philippines

Term

December 28, 2022 – 2029

Born

May 7, 1983
Lanao del Sur, Philippines

Nationality

Filipino

Alma Mater

Philippine School of Business Administration (BSBA)
Far Eastern University (MBA)
San Beda University (LL.B.)

Occupation

Lawyer, Public Administrator, Human Rights Advocate

Parents

Atty. Sultan Salic Biston Dumarpa (father)
Faysah Racman Pimping Maniri Dumarpa (mother)

Notability

First Muslim woman appointed Commissioner in the history of the Philippine Commission on Human Rights

Known For

Focal Commissioner for Gender Equality, Persons Deprived of Liberty, and Emerging Technologies at the CHR

Contents

1 EARLY LIFE AND FAMILY
2 EDUCATION
3 CAREER
4 COMMISSION ON HUMAN RIGHTS
5 LEGACY AND SIGNIFICANCE
6 SEE ALSO
7 REFERENCES

EARLY LIFE AND FAMILY

Dumarpa hails from Lanao del Sur in the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM), and she comes from a family with deep ties to Philippine law and regional politics. Her father, Atty. Sultan Salic Biston Dumarpa, is a lawyer and former Commissioner of the National Labor Relations Commission (NLRC). Her mother, Faysah Racman Pimping Maniri Dumarpa, served as Congresswoman for the 1st District of Lanao del Sur.

EDUCATION

Dumarpa's academic path wove together business, management, and law. She earned her Bachelor of Science in Business Administration, majoring in Marketing, from the Philippine School of Business Administration (PSBA). She then pursued a Master's degree in Business Administration (MBA) at Far Eastern University (FEU).

She went on to study law at San Beda University, completing her Bachelor of Laws (LL.B.) in 2010. She passed the Philippine Bar Examinations and was admitted to the Philippine Bar in 2012.

CAREER

- **Legislative and Corporate Law (2001-2020)**

Dumarpa's public service career began in 2001, when she joined the House of Representatives as a Political Affairs Officer, a post she held for nine years while building a foundation in statutory research and legislative policy work.

She later moved to the Senate of the Philippines as a Legislative Staff Officer, taking on a supervising role within the office by 2013.

She then shifted into corporate practice, serving as a corporate lawyer for the National Power Corporation (NAPOCOR) starting in 2013. She also held a legal role with the Land Bank of the Philippines during this period.

- **Executive Bureaucracy (2021-2022)**

In 2021, Dumarpa was appointed Deputy Executive Director III for Administrative and Financial Service at the National Nutrition Council (NNC) under the Department of Health. In this post, she coordinated with international, local, and private stakeholders to help fund and implement nutrition programs on the ground.

In September 2022, she joined the Procurement Service of the Department of Budget and Management (PS-DBM) as Director IV of the Administrative and Finance Group, overseeing budgeting, human resource operations, and general services for the agency.

COMMISSION ON HUMAN RIGHTS

- **Gender Equality and Women's Rights**

As the lead of the Gender Equality and Women's Human Rights Center (GEWHRC), Dumarpa carries out the CHR's mandate as the state's Gender and Development Ombud under the Magna Carta of Women (RA 9710). Her work touches on compliance with laws such as the Safe Spaces Act, the Anti-Violence Against Women and Their Children Act, and the Responsible Parenthood and Reproductive Health Act.

- **Persons Deprived of Liberty**

Dumarpa also serves as Focal Commissioner for Persons Deprived of Liberty (PDLs), leading jail visitation programs across the country. Her work in this space centers on assessing overcrowding, sanitation, and the specific health risks faced by women in detention, using international standards as a benchmark for reform.

- **Emerging Technologies and Cybercrime**

As Focal Commissioner for Emerging Technologies, Dumarpa leads CHR discussions on how digital tools intersect with human rights, from data privacy to AI surveillance to government cybersecurity. She has issued public statements on hacking incidents targeting government agencies, framing them as threats to Filipinos' right to privacy under the Data Privacy Act of 2012.

LEGACY AND SIGNIFICANCE

As a high ranking Muslim Filipino woman in a constitutional office, Dumarpa represents a rare and important voice for Mindanao and the Bangsamoro region within the country's national human rights machinery. Her own words to the United Nations Human Rights Council in March 2023 underscored this milestone, noting that in the 38 years since the Commission's creation, she was the first Muslim woman ever appointed as Commissioner.

Some civil society groups initially viewed her appointment with caution, given that her background came from executive bureaucracy rather than grassroots activism. Over time, her command of institutional finance, administrative law, and public policy has been credited with helping turn advocacy work into funded, structurally sound government programs.

SEE ALSO

- Commission on Human Rights of the Philippines
- Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
- Lanao del Sur

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